

Credentials and Passkeys



BIG IDEA Length beats cleverness, reuse is the real risk, and your email and phone number are the master keys to everything else. Passkeys and password managers make strong security easier.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R2 Passphrase Word Table (6x6, 36 words) and Recovery Map card per student, one die per pair, Workbook W2. Students enter no real passwords anywhere.

- ☐ Copy R2 for each student; one die per pair.
- ☐ Write “length beats cleverness” and “reuse is the real risk” on the board.
- ☐ Know the door ranking: (e) weakest, then (a), (b), (c), (d) strongest.

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script Say: “Quick poll, hands up, nobody says anything out loud: who reuses one password, or a close variant, across more than one account? Keep it up if one of them matters, like email. That is almost everyone, and it is no character flaw. The system is hard. When one site gets breached, the stolen list of emails and passwords gets tried on other sites automatically. The attacker does not need to guess you. They just try the list. The real risk is that my one password was already sitting on a list. The fix is boring and strong: unique and long, and where possible, no password at all.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Passphrase Builder and Recovery Map*

- 1 (3 min) Roll a passphrase.** Roll the die twice per word for the row and column of the 36-word table; four words. Dice chose it, so it is unpredictable. Compare it with “Fluffy2009!” and decide which a guesser tries first. It is for practice only: never use it as a real password.
- 2 (3 min) Recovery Map.** Draw your own master-key chain with no account names or passwords: which account can reset the most others? Arrow each account to its recovery method. Circle the single point of failure and star the account needing the strongest protection. “If I own your email, I can reset almost everything.”
- 3 (2 min) Rank the doors** weakest to strongest: (a) password only; (b) password and a texted code; (c) password and an authenticator app code; (d) a passkey or security key; (e) a password reused on three sites plus a texted code. Never read a code to anyone who contacts you.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why do people reuse passwords even though they know it is risky? What would make not reusing easier?”
- 2** “If you could only fix one account today, which would it be and why?”
- 3** “Someone gets your phone. What could they reach? What would you change?”

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause before you type a password or code anywhere you reached by a link. Check by going to the site or app yourself. Tell a trusted adult if someone asks for your password, even someone you like. Add to your Defense Plan: ‘My strongest-protected account will be _____, and I will use _____ on it.’”

Hand signal: Hackles up? A message pushing you to log in or share a code is a classic trigger (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Long, unique, second door.”

EXIT TICKET “Which account is your master key, and what is one step you will take to protect it?”

FUN BOOST Door-Rank Debate. Split the room by whether they ranked (e) or (a) weaker. Each side gets 60 seconds. Grade the reasoning, not the order.

LEVEL-UP Family Recovery Kit. On paper, list what a recovery kit should hold (no real codes) and do the master-key check with an adult at home.

DIFFERENTIATE Give a pre-drawn Recovery Map for a fictional student (“Imani”) and ask for the single point of failure.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Which of our accounts is the master key, and how is it protected?” Agree that nobody reads a verification code to anyone who contacts them. A family code word helps.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you...?” or “How could you...?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- “You should have told someone sooner.”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.